

# Competitive Positioning

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*Cymbal Voyages Brand Studio · Agency onboarding packet · Last updated September 2026*

Three competitors define the space we work in. Each is good at something we are not, and each leaves room for what we do. This page is for planning and briefs. In customer-facing copy we never name a competitor, never make a comparative claim, and never imply one; see the legal claims list. The Brand Studio agent may reference these names in briefs and internal notes only.

## Where we stand

Cymbal Voyages sells curated flights, hotels and packages to customers who plan ahead, and we keep them through Cymbal Compass. Our signature category is the warm escape booked from a cold-weather market between August and January. We are a mid-size brand, and we compete by knowing our customers better than a large site can and by offering more choice at a lower price than a bespoke planner will. Our price is honest and shown in full. Our loyalty program rewards return with points that feel like recognition. Our copy sounds like a well-travelled friend.

## Sunward Getaways

A discount deal aggregator. Sunward pulls unsold inventory from many suppliers and pushes it out with heavy percent-off framing, countdown timers and a daily email.

What they do well: speed and price on last-minute inventory. If a customer wants to leave on Friday and does not care much where, Sunward will find the lowest-cost way to do it, and its email list is very large.

Where we win: customers who plan. Our warm-escape customer books in September for February, wants a specific kind of place, and does not want to sort through 40 listings of uneven quality. Our packages are chosen, our prices include taxes and fees up front, and our members are rewarded for coming back rather than trained to wait for a sale. CMP-006 showed us what happens when we try to sound like Sunward: bookings fell 40 percent under target and our best members felt cheapened.

How to talk about them: describe the alternative, never the company; say "we choose fewer, better options and show you the full price" and let the reader draw the comparison.

## Meridian Bespoke Travel

A high-touch luxury planner. Meridian assigns a personal advisor who builds a custom itinerary, books everything by hand and charges a planning fee on top of premium rates.

What they do well: attention. A Meridian client gets a phone call, a hand-picked villa and someone to fix problems mid-trip. The experience is personal, and the clients who can afford it are loyal.

Where we win: value and reach. Most of our customers want a chosen, well-described trip at a mid-market price without a planning fee, and they want to book it tonight from the sofa. We give them curation without the advisor, honest destination copy that helps them decide, and a loyalty program that remembers them. Meridian cannot serve a family of four in Milwaukee looking for a \$1,300-per-person week in Punta Cana; we can, and well.

How to talk about them: never suggest we are a luxury planner; say "curated" and "chosen by us," and describe the specific detail that shows we know the place.

## FareStack

A large price-comparison booking site. FareStack indexes flights and hotels from nearly every supplier, sorts by price, and books at scale with thin margins and minimal service.

What they do well: breadth and search. If a customer knows exactly what they want, FareStack will find it and the price will be competitive. Its brand-search bidding is a factor in the 9 percent year-over-year rise in our own brand-search cost per booking (CMP-001).

Where we win: the customer who does not yet know exactly what they want. FareStack offers a list; we offer a recommendation with a reason. Our packages bundle flight and hotel at a price that is shown per person with taxes and fees included, and our Compass program gives a reason to return that a comparison site cannot match. Winning against FareStack means being specific on our destination pages and on paid search, and keeping the price frame honest so that a customer who does compare finds no surprise.

How to talk about them: never claim a lower price than anyone; say what the price includes and what we chose, and leave the comparing to the customer.